11.1 Burns (Acute Phase)*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I am very thirsty." **Objective** • Partial- and full-thickness burns, 30% TBSA • HR 125/min, BP 96/60 mmHg • Urine 20 mL/hour	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to capillary leak and evaporative loss through burned skin as evidenced by tachycardia, hypotension and low urine output.	• Within 8 hours, urine 0.5 mL/kg/hour (adult) and stable vital signs.	• Insert two large-bore cannulas and start resuscitation by the prescribed burn formula. • Measure urine hourly through the catheter. • Adjust fluids to urine output, as ordered. • Take vital signs hourly and follow electrolytes. • Weigh daily.	• Achieved when urine output is on target.
Subjective • "The pain is unbearable." • Rates pain 9/10 **Objective** • Partial-thickness burns • Crying and restless	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to burn injury and exposed nerve endings as evidenced by a pain score of 9/10 and restlessness.	• Pain at or below 4/10 at rest; tolerates dressing changes.	• Give IV opioids as prescribed; avoid the IM route in the acute phase. • Give analgesia 30 minutes before dressings are changed. • Keep wounds covered so that air does not reach them. • Use distraction and explain each step.	• Outcome reached when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Skin barrier lost • Invasive lines • Burn wound	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: loss of skin integrity and invasive devices.	• No wound or systemic infection.	• Use strict aseptic technique for wound care. • Apply topical antimicrobial dressings as prescribed. • Watch the wound's appearance and smell, and the temperature. • Give tetanus prophylaxis as ordered.	• Considered met if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [39], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.